

Ordinary Differential Equations

Through the Lens of Nets

Omkar Tasgaonkar

otasgaonkar@ucla.edu

I am writing this document as my own personal notes regarding analysis and differential equations. I am attempting to cover nets and compactness rigorously in order to precisely explore Integration and Arzela-Ascoli (and related theorems/statements), which are key to the study of Ordinary Differential Equations.

Another topic I plan to treat thoroughly is the topic of total variation and bounded variation, which is recurrent with regards to the Riemann-Stieltjes integral.

Textbooks Used to Develop these Notes:

1. *Principles of Mathematical Analysis* - Walter Rudin
2. *Mathematical Analysis* - Tom Apostol (for integration)
3. *General Topology* - John Kelley (for nets)
4. *Theory of Ordinary Differential Equations* - Earl Coddington, Norman Levinson
5. *Measure, Integration, and Real Analysis* - Sheldon Axler (for measure theory)

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0 Nets and Sequences

0.1 First Countability

What has been giving us sequential equivalence in $\mathbb{R}$ is the first countability of $\mathbb{R}$ (which means around any point x , there exists a countable basis). We used this to prove the more general properties implied sequential properties (by using the first countable property to construct/apply subsequences).

To state more rigorously, a space X is first countable if, given some point $x \in X$ and countably infinite set of local nested neighborhoods of x which we denote as $\mathcal{B}_x := \{B_n : n \in \mathbb{N}\}$, then:

$$\forall U_x, \exists n_0 \in \mathbb{N}, \forall n \geq n_0 : B_n \subseteq U_x$$

where U_x is any arbitrary neighborhood of x .

All metric spaces are first countable; but there are some topological spaces that are not first countable. Consider the following topology on $\mathbb{R}$:

$$\tau := \{\emptyset\} \cup \{\mathbb{R} \setminus F : F \text{ is finite}\}$$

Now take some point $x \in \mathbb{R}$ and assume it has some countable basis $\mathcal{B}_x := \{B_n\}_{n \in \mathbb{N}}$, in which case:

$$\forall n \in \mathbb{N} : B_n = \mathbb{R} \setminus F_n$$

Then, the following set should be countably infinite:

$$\bigcup_{n \in \mathbb{N}} (\mathbb{R} \setminus B_n)$$

since each F_n is finite. We note that:

$$\bigcup_{n \in \mathbb{N}} (\mathbb{R} \setminus B_n) = \mathbb{R} \setminus \bigcap_{n \in \mathbb{N}} B_n = \mathbb{R} \setminus \{x\}$$

which is a contradiction, since $\mathbb{R}$ is not countably infinite and removing one point does not change this fact. Notice the intersection of the basis elements is solely x . That is because the topology is T_1 , which means we can find some open set containing x that separates x and any other arbitrary point. Then by basis definition, there is some $B_n \subseteq O_x$.

This same T_1 condition idea with basis elements gives equivalence of a limit point and ω -limit point in the next section. The key takeaway is that directions in proofs that aim to prove the existence of some topological object implies the existence of a sequential characterization require first countability.

0.2 Nets

We begin by introducing the notion of a directed set:

Definition 0.1. We define an ordering relation $\geq$ for the set D and call it a directed set under the following conditions:

1. Reflexive: $\forall x \in D : x \geq x$
2. Transitive: $\forall x, y, z \in D : x \geq y \wedge y \geq z \implies x \geq z$

3. *Directed*: $\forall x, y \in D, \exists z \in D : (z \geq x \wedge z \geq y) \vee (x \geq z \wedge y \geq z)$

Notice that the first two properties align with a partial order. However a partial order also requires anti-symmetry, which means:

$$x \geq y \wedge y \geq x \implies x = y$$

which is not required for a directed set. This will become quite important later on. The third property (which is direction) tells us whether the net is upward directed (the left side condition) or downward directed (the right side), or both!

We also say that element x follows element y if $x \geq y$.

We view an equivalent property, for which WLOG, we assume an upward directed set D :

Lemma 0.1. *Given $(D, \geq)$ an upward directed set, then for all finite subsets S of D :*

$$\forall S \subseteq D, \exists z \in D, \forall x \in S : z \geq x \iff \forall x, y \in D, \exists z \in D : z \geq x \wedge z \geq y$$

In other words, all finite subsets of the directed set admit an upper bound.

Proof. $\implies$: The forward direction is trivial as a two element subset is finite.

$\impliedby$: For the converse we prove via induction. The base case is a finite set of two elements, which we are given is true. Now assume it holds for a finite set of n elements such that:

$$S_n := \{x_i : 0 \leq i \leq n-1\} \wedge \forall x_i \in S_n, \exists z \in D : x_i \leq z$$

Now consider $S_{n+1} := S_n \cup \{x_n\}$ where x_n is different from all elements in S_n . Then we get that, by the base case:

$$\exists w \in D : x_n \leq w \wedge z \leq w$$

and finally by transitivity, we obtain that $\forall x_i \in S_{n+1} : x_i \leq w$. □

For the remainder of these notes, we assume a directed set D is upward directed unless stated otherwise (the downward directed set notion will also be useful). Now a net is built on a directed set by the following:

Definition 0.2. *A net is a function $\omega : D \rightarrow X$ where D is a directed set and X is a topological space.*

We define net convergence as the following. Now, to bring about the similarity to sequences, we shall denote a net as $\{x_\alpha\}_{\alpha \in D}$ where D is the directed set. This is still a function where $x_\alpha = \omega(\alpha)$, but this representation shows D as an indexing set.

Now in full generality of an arbitrary topological space, we say that the net converges or that $x_\alpha \rightarrow x$ if:

$$\forall U_x \in \tau_X, \exists \alpha_0 \in D, \forall \alpha \geq \alpha_0 : x_\alpha \in U_x$$

where U_x is an arbitrary open neighborhood of the point $x \in X$ with the topology τ_X . For the majority of these notes, we shall work in metric spaces (X, ϱ) (unless stated otherwise), so we can instead say:

$$\forall \epsilon > 0, \exists \alpha_0 \in D, \forall \alpha \geq \alpha_0 : x_\alpha \in B(c, \epsilon) \iff \varrho(x_\alpha, x) < \epsilon$$

so if our directed set $D = \mathbb{N}$, we obtain a sequence. We can alternatively characterize convergence by the following definition:

Definition 0.3. *The tail of a net at α_0 is defined as:*

$$T_{\alpha_0} := \{x_\alpha : \alpha \geq \alpha_0\}$$

Then a net converges to some x if and only if $\forall \epsilon > 0, \exists \alpha_0 \in D$ such that:

$$T_{\alpha_0} \subseteq B(x, \epsilon)$$

0.3 Cluster Points of Sequences

We introduce a related concept from the lens of sequences:

Definition 0.4. *A sequence frequently visits a set A if:*

$$\forall n_0 \geq 0, \exists n \geq n_0 : x_n \in A$$

So a cluster point of a sequence is defined as the following:

Definition 0.5. *x is a cluster point of $\{x_n\}_{n \in \mathbb{N}}$ if $\{x_n\}_{n \in \mathbb{N}}$ frequently visits all open neighborhoods of x .*

The notion of a cluster point is something we will bring about when talking about nets and sequences. Considering metric spaces, we get the definition of a cluster point as:

$$\forall \epsilon > 0, \forall n_0 \geq 0, \exists n \geq n_0 : x_n \in B(x, \epsilon)$$

which permits $x_n = x$ unlike a **limit point of a set**, though there is an eventual connection. We view the following lemma:

Lemma 0.2. *x is a cluster point of $\{x_n\}_{n \in \mathbb{N}} \in X^{\mathbb{N}}$ if and only if $\exists \{n_k\}_{k \in \mathbb{N}} \in \mathbb{N}^{\mathbb{N}} : x_{n_k} \rightarrow x$*

Proof. $\implies$: If x is a cluster point, then:

$$\forall \epsilon > 0, \forall n_0 \geq 0, \exists n \geq n_0 : x_n \in B(x, \epsilon)$$

We DO NOT require Axiom of Choice for this proof, as the definition of the cluster point provides us a method of construction. Define the following:

$$\epsilon_m := \frac{1}{m+1}$$

Then, for $m = 0$, choose $n_0 = 0$, which gives some $n \geq 0$ such that $x_n \in B(x, \epsilon_0)$. Call this the first term of the subsequence as n_0 (different from the first n_0).

Then for ϵ_1 , we can find some $n \geq n_0 + 1$ such that $x_n \in B(x, \epsilon_1)$. Repeat this for all $m \in \mathbb{N}$, so that:

$$\forall k \in \mathbb{N} : n_k < n_{k+1} \wedge \forall \epsilon > 0, \exists k_0 \geq 0, \forall k \geq k_0 : |x_{n_k} - x| < \epsilon$$

because by the Archimedian property, we are guaranteed to find some $m \in \mathbb{N}$ such that:

$$\frac{1}{m+1} \leq \epsilon \implies \exists n_m \geq 0, \forall n_k \geq n_m : |x_{n_k} - x| < \frac{1}{k+1} \leq \frac{1}{m+1} \leq \epsilon$$

which now shows convergence by Definition 0.2 and can also be phrased in terms of Definition 0.3.

$\Leftarrow$: If there exists a convergent subsequence, then:

$$\forall \epsilon > 0, \exists n_0 \geq 0, \forall n \geq n_0 : x_n \in B(x, \epsilon)$$

This lemma shows us that the limit of a sequence is always a cluster point (not necessarily the converse) because convergence is a stricter condition. We see that:

$$\forall \epsilon > 0, \forall n'_0 \geq 0, \exists n \geq n'_0 : x_n \in B(x, \epsilon)$$

because if $n'_0 < n_0$, then $n = n_0$ satisfies the condition of a cluster point. If $n'_0 \geq n_0$, then simply choosing $n = n'_0$ satisfies the condition because by convergence $T_{n_0} \subseteq B(x, \epsilon)$. $\square$

Notice how (aside from the construction of the subsequence) did not use any properties specific to that of integers. Another thing is the limit of a convergent sequence is a cluster point, but the converse is not necessarily true. This gives rise to nets as we only require the properties of directed sets.

0.4 Subsets of Directed Sets

Definition 0.6. Given a directed set D , we call a subset $E \subseteq D$ cofinal if:

$$\forall \alpha \in D, \exists \alpha' \in E : \alpha' \geq \alpha$$

Cofinality is key in defining the concept of subnets (for which we will explore two separate definitions). We also see the following connection with cluster points/frequently in a set:

Lemma 0.3. Given some topological space X and some subset A , a net $\{x_\alpha\}_{\alpha \in D}$ in X is frequently in A if and only if there exists a cofinal subset E such that:

$$\forall \alpha \in E : x_\alpha \in A$$

This follows from definition 0.6 given above. If there exists a cofinal subset E , then:

$$\forall \alpha \in D, \exists \alpha' \in E : \alpha' \geq \alpha$$

Combined with the fact that the image of E is in A , we see that:

$$\forall \alpha \in D, \exists \alpha' \geq \alpha : x_{\alpha'} \in A$$

This only proves one direction, but the other direction is constructive in nature (to show the existence of E simply follows from the definition of the net being frequently in A).

We also see that cofinal subsets are directed. Let E be a cofinal subset of a directed set D . Then by subset relations, it inherits the ordering ($\geq$) and is reflexive. We need to prove property 3 in Definition 0.1 only.

Consider some $\alpha', \alpha'' \in E$. We get that there must be some $\alpha \in D$ such that:

$$\alpha \geq \alpha' \wedge \alpha \geq \alpha''$$

Now by cofinality, there exists some $\alpha''' \in E$ such that $\alpha''' \geq \alpha$, so by transitivity, the directedness of E follows.

We say that a net converges if it is eventually in all open neighborhoods of x .

Let us examine the primary definition (**General Topology, Kelley**) we will use for a subnet:

Definition 0.7. Given a net $\{x_\alpha\}_{\alpha \in D}$ a subnet is the function $\omega \circ f$, where $f : E \rightarrow D$ and ω for some directed set $(E, \succ)$ was the initial net such that $\omega : D \rightarrow X$.

We denote the subnet by $\{x_{f(\beta)}\}_{\beta \in E}$, which must adhere by the following property:

$$\forall \alpha \in D, \exists \beta_0 \in E, \forall \beta \succ \beta_0 : f(\beta) \geq \alpha$$

The intuition behind this definition

Now consider some cofinal subset of D , which we will call E with the same ordering $\geq$. Then cofinality gives us that:

$$\forall \alpha \in D, \exists \beta_0 \in E : \beta_0 \geq \alpha \iff \forall \alpha \in D, \exists \beta_0 \in E, \forall \beta \geq \beta_0 : \beta \geq \alpha$$

which follows from transitivity. So $\{x_\alpha\}_{\alpha \in E}$ is a subnet of the initial net with f being the identity function, which is similar to convergence properties of subsequences and cluster points. Using this fact, we can extend Lemma 0.3 to the following:

Lemma 0.4. Given some topological space X and some subset A , a net $\{x_\alpha\}_{\alpha \in D}$ in X is frequently in A if and only if there exists a subnet contained in A .

Proof. The proof utilizes the results of the previous definition. Lemma 0.3 gave us equivalence with the existence of some cofinal subset $E \subseteq D$ that maps into A . A cofinal subset is essentially a subnet under composition with the identity function, thus giving our desired equivalence. $\square$

This can be extended to the notion of convergence, essentially bringing about a parallel lemma to Lemma 0.2 stated in terms of nets:

Lemma 0.5. $x \in X$ is a cluster point of $\{x_\alpha\}_{\alpha \in D}$ if and only if $\exists \{x_{f(\alpha')}\}_{\alpha' \in E} : x_{f(\alpha')} \rightarrow x$

Proof. A cluster point can be defined as one for which the net is frequently in all neighborhoods of the point U_x . By the previous lemma, we can say that x is a cluster point if and only if there is a subnet contained in each neighborhood, but that is quite weak and difficult to check. Let us define E as the following:

$$E := \{(\alpha', U_x) : x_{\alpha'} \in U_x\}$$

$\implies$: We show that E is a directed set that brings about a subnet $\{x_{f(\alpha')}\}_{\alpha' \in E}$. E is directed under the product ordering whereby:

$$(\alpha', U_x) \succ (\alpha'_1, V_x) \iff \alpha'_1 \geq \alpha' \wedge V_x \subseteq U_x$$

So taking any two (α', U_x) and (α'_1, V_x) in E , we see that by the ordering of D :

$$\exists \alpha'_2 \in D : \alpha'_2 \geq \alpha' \wedge \alpha'_2 \geq \alpha'_1$$

and similarly for the neighborhoods, we have that:

$$V_x \cap U_x \subseteq V_x \wedge V_x \cap U_x \subseteq U_x$$

Now the pair $(\alpha'_2, V_x \cap U_x)$ may not belong to E , but by the cluster point definition for all neighborhoods of x , we have the existence of some α'_3 , such that:

$$x_{\alpha'_3} \in V_x \cap U_x \implies (\alpha'_3, V_x \cap U_x) \in E$$

Now that we have established that E is directed (the other two properties trivially follow from subset inclusion and directedness of D). Now, we define the function $f : E \rightarrow D$ such that:

$$\forall(\alpha', U_x) \in E : f(\alpha', U_x) = \alpha'$$

We can show that this is a subnet (specifically a Kelley subnet, but later we will show it is also a Willard subnet). The existence of the cluster point x gives us that D is frequently in all neighborhoods:

$$\begin{aligned} \forall U_x, \forall \alpha \in D, \exists \alpha_1 \geq \alpha : x_{\alpha_1} \in U_x &\implies (\alpha_1, U_x) \in E \\ \implies \forall U_x, \forall \alpha \in D, \exists (\alpha_1, U_x) \in E : f(\alpha_1, U_x) &\geq \alpha \end{aligned}$$

And by directedness of E , we see that:

$$\implies \forall U_x, \forall \alpha \in D, \exists (\alpha_1, U_x) \in E, \forall (\alpha_2, V_x) \succ (\alpha_1, U_x) : f(\alpha_2, V_x) \geq \alpha$$

Thus proving that $\{x_{f(\alpha, V_x)}\}_{(\alpha, V_x) \in E}$ is a Kelley subnet. It follows that the subnet converges to x as:

$$\implies \forall U_x, \exists (\alpha_1, U_x) \in E, \forall (\alpha_2, V_x) \succ (\alpha_1, U_x) : x_{\alpha_2} \in V_x \subseteq U_x$$

as it is eventually in each neighborhood of x . We now prove the converse:

$\Leftarrow$: If x is not a cluster point of the net, then:

$$\exists U_x, \exists \alpha \in D, \forall \alpha_1 \geq \alpha : x_{\alpha_1} \notin U_x$$

Then for all possible subnets/cofinal subsets:

$$\forall \alpha \in D, \exists \alpha'_0 \in E, \forall \alpha' \geq \alpha'_0 : f(\alpha') \geq \alpha$$

we get that:

$$\implies \exists U_x, \exists \alpha'_0 \in E, \forall \alpha' \geq \alpha'_0 : f(\alpha') \in D \wedge f(\alpha') \geq \alpha \implies x_{f(\alpha')} \notin U_x$$

which means that any subnet is not eventually in a neighborhood of x , thus there exists no subnet that converges to x . $\square$

Notice we can do the same proof in a first countable space with sequences; however, this construction will not give us a subsequence (because it is not a map from $\mathbb{N}$ to $\mathbb{N}$), rather a subnet, showing that a subsequence is a subnet but not necessarily the converse.

Let us examine a different definition of a subnet (**General Topology, Willard**):

Definition 0.8. Given a net $\{x_\alpha\}_{\alpha \in D}$, we define a subnet $\{x_{f(\alpha')}\}_{\alpha' \in E}$ by the following conditions:

1. $\forall \alpha \in D, \exists \alpha'_0 \in E, f(\alpha'_0) \geq \alpha$
2. $f : E \rightarrow D$ is order preserving such that:

$$\forall \alpha'_0, \alpha'_1 \in E : \alpha'_0 \succ \alpha'_1 \implies f(\alpha'_0) \geq f(\alpha'_1)$$

The Willard definition implies the Kelley definition (we can use condition two to derive the Kelley condition), however the converse is not necessarily true.

The Willard definition is strictly stronger with the order preserving function, but the intuition behind both is that the indexing terms $f(E)$ go "further" in D . Our traditional definition of a subsequence is a Willard subnet, but it can possibly be relaxed to fit Kelley's definition.

We write such a condition as follows:

Definition 0.9. We define a (Willard) subsequence as $\{x_{n_k}\}_{k \in \mathbb{N}}$ where $\{n_k\}_{k \in \mathbb{N}}$ is a strictly increasing sequence. In other words, we have a function:

$$\exists f : \mathbb{N} \rightarrow \mathbb{N} \text{ such that } \forall k, j \in \mathbb{N} : k > j \implies f(k) = n_k > n_j = f(j)$$

The first condition is satisfied the condition that $\forall k \in \mathbb{N} : n_k \geq k$, which can be proven inductively.

We define a (Kelley) subsequence as $\{x_{n_k}\}_{k \in \mathbb{N}}$ where for $\{n_k\}_{k \in \mathbb{N}}$, we have a that:

$$\forall n \in \mathbb{N}, \exists k_0 \in \mathbb{N}, \forall k > k_0 : n_k > n$$

Note that Kelley does use $\geq$ in this definition, however this effectively means a singular value of a single index can create a subsequence.

What this means is we can have a Kelley subsequence with indices such as $n_0 = 1, n_1 = 3, n_2 = 2$, while this would not be allowed in a Willard subsequence.

Now in terms of analysis, because of the total ordering of $\mathbb{R}$, we will deal with Willard subnets naturally, though I plan to explicitly use this terminology defined in this section regarding nets in the next section. That way, the connection between the concepts and nets is stronger.

0.5 Nets In Analysis

0.5.1 Oscillation as a Net

We have the oscillation characterization of continuity of a function f at a point $x_0 \in \text{int}(\text{Dom}(f))$ as:

$$\forall \epsilon > 0, \exists \delta_0 > 0, \forall \delta \leq \delta_0 : \sup_{x, y \in B(x_0, \delta)} |f(x) - f(y)| \leq \epsilon$$

where we write the net as $\{\text{osc}(f, B(x_0, \delta))\}_{\delta > 0}$ and:

$$\text{osc}(f, B(x_0, \delta)) := \sup_{x, y \in B(x_0, \delta)} |f(x) - f(y)|$$

where the downward directed set is $(\mathbb{R}_{>0}, \leq)$ as the domain of the net.

Let us view an important related result:

Theorem 0.1. $f : \mathbb{R} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ is continuous at x_0 if and only if for all δ -nets:

$$\forall \{x_\delta\}_{\delta > 0} : x_\delta \rightarrow x_0 \implies f(x_\delta) \rightarrow f(x_0)$$

Proof. $\implies$: If f is continuous at x_0 , then we have that:

$$\forall \epsilon > 0, \exists \delta_0 > 0, \forall x \in B(x_0, \delta_0) : f(x) \in B(f(x_0), \epsilon)$$

Then consider all δ -nets that converge to x_0 , we have that:

$$\forall U_{x_0}, \exists \delta_\alpha > 0, \forall \delta \leq \delta_\alpha : x_\delta \in B(x_0, \delta_\alpha) \subseteq U_{x_0}$$

Then letting $U_x = B(x_0, \delta_0)$, for all convergent δ -nets:

$$\exists \delta_\alpha > 0, \forall \delta \leq \delta_\alpha : x_\delta \in B(x_0, \delta_0)$$

which by continuity implies that $f(x_\delta) \in B(f(x_0), \epsilon)$, so for all convergent δ -nets:

$$\implies \forall \epsilon > 0, \exists \delta_\alpha > 0, \forall \delta \leq \delta_\alpha : f(x_\delta) \in B(f(x_0), \epsilon)$$

proving that $\forall \{x_\delta\}_{\delta>0} : f(x_\delta) \rightarrow f(x_0)$.

$\Leftarrow$: We prove by contrapositive. If f is not continuous at x_0 , then we have that:

$$\exists \epsilon > 0, \forall \delta > 0, \exists x \in B(x_0, \delta) : f(x) \notin B(f(x_0), \epsilon)$$

and we want to show there exists a convergent δ -net whose image is not converging to $f(x_0)$. For this we require Axiom of Choice (and notice we do not require first countability).

Construct the net $\{x_\delta\}_{\delta>0}$ such that:

$$\forall \delta > 0 : x_\delta \in B(x_0, \delta) \wedge f(x_\delta) \notin B(f(x_0), \epsilon)$$

which is clearly a convergent net. However the image net $\{f(x_\delta)\}_{\delta>0}$ is not convergent because:

$$\exists \epsilon > 0, \forall \delta > 0, \exists \delta_0 = \delta : f(x_{\delta_0}) \notin B(f(x_0), \epsilon)$$

thus proving the converse. □

What this theorem says is that a function f is (pointwise) continuous at x_0 if and only if for all nets convergent to x_0 , their image converges to $f(x_0)$. This idea allows us to formalize the following notion:

$$\lim_{x_\delta \rightarrow x_0} f(x_\delta) = f(x_0)$$

where below the limit is the convergence of the δ -net and the entire operation represents convergence of the image. A similar theorem can be stated for differentiability and as we will see in the future, integrability.

While in general, texts define the above notation as the limit via $\epsilon - \delta$ and punctured δ -balls, to maintain consistency, we will write a net converges as $x_\delta \rightarrow x_0$ and use the above notation only when a convergence of a net implies the convergence of its image under a function.

Now relative to this theorem, we can call oscillation as the "worst case δ -net", which if it converges to zero, then all other nets must too converge to the function value (follows from completeness). We can manipulate the oscillation criterion further:

$$\begin{aligned} \forall \epsilon > 0, \exists \delta_0 > 0, \forall \delta \leq \delta_0 : -\epsilon \leq 0 \leq \sup_{x, y \in B(x_0, \delta)} |f(x) - f(y)| \leq \epsilon \\ \implies \forall \epsilon > 0, \exists \delta_0 > 0, \forall \delta \leq \delta_0 : |\text{osc}(f, B(x_0, \delta)) - 0| \leq \epsilon \end{aligned}$$

so $T_{\delta_0} \subseteq B(0, \epsilon)$, thus proving the net:

$$\text{osc}(f, B(x_0, \delta)) \rightarrow 0$$

The main goal of this section is to jump to nets for integration and sequences of functions. However, as I write notes down for those, I will definitely revisit and improve this section. The reason why I wanted to highlight oscillation as a net is so the reader can draw similar parallels with integration and function criterions.

1 Compactness

In the previous section, we discussed notions of convergence and adherence for sequences. We now discuss these notions for sets. Let us view the following theorem:

1.1 Limit Points

We start off with a topological proof, which will be key to discussing limit and adherent points:

Lemma 1.1. *The closure of a set A is equal to all of its adherent points.*

Proof. $\implies$: We prove by contrapositive. If x is not an adherent point, then:

$$\exists \epsilon > 0 : B(x, \epsilon) \cap A = \emptyset \implies B(x, \epsilon) \subseteq X \setminus A$$

So x is an interior point of $X \setminus A$, which means:

$$x \in \text{int}(X \setminus A) = X \setminus \overline{A}$$

$\Leftarrow$: We once again prove by contrapositive. If $x \notin \overline{A}$, then:

$$x \in X \setminus \overline{A} \subseteq X \setminus A \implies x \in X \setminus A$$

Since $x \in X \setminus \overline{A}$ is open, then x must be an interior point, so:

$$\exists \epsilon > 0 : B(x, \epsilon) \subseteq X \setminus A \implies \exists \epsilon > 0 : B(x, \epsilon) \cap A = \emptyset$$

□

The limits of sequences ARE NOT necessarily limit points. Given some subset $E \subseteq \mathbb{R}$, x is a limit point of E if:

$$\forall \epsilon > 0 : B(x, \epsilon) \cap E \neq \emptyset$$

Notice how this only requires the intersection to be nonempty; which means there could possibly be a finite number of points in the intersection (but we will see this is not possible). Let us look at the following lemma:

Lemma 1.2. *x is a limit point of E if and only if*

$$\exists \{x_n\}_{n \in \mathbb{N}} \in (E \setminus \{x\})^{\mathbb{N}} : x_n \rightarrow x$$

Proof. $\implies$: If x is a limit point, then using the first countability of metric spaces, consider:

$$\epsilon_n := \frac{1}{n+1}$$

Then by axiom of choice, choose $x_n \in B(x, \epsilon_n) \cap E \setminus \{x\}$, so that:

$$\forall n \in \mathbb{N} : |x_n - x| < \frac{1}{n+1} \implies x_n \rightarrow x$$

$\Leftarrow$: Now for the converse. If there exists such a sequence $\{x_n\}_{n \in \mathbb{N}}$ such that:

$$\forall \epsilon > 0, \exists n_0 \geq 0, \forall n \geq n_0 : |x_n - x| < \epsilon$$

then we see that

$$\forall \epsilon > 0 : B(x, \epsilon) \cap E \setminus \{x\} \neq \emptyset$$

as $\forall n \geq n_0 : x_n \in B(x, \epsilon)$ and by definition of the sequence $x_n \in E \setminus \{x\}$. Thus proving equivalence. □

Now we introduce the following notion:

Definition 1.1. *An ω -limit point of a set E is one for which there exists a countably infinite number of points of E within each punctured ϵ -ball around x .*

It follows that every limit point in $\mathbb{R}$ is an ω -limit point from Lemma 1.2, the sequential definition. This is because:

$$\forall \epsilon > 0, \exists n_0 \geq 0, \forall n \geq n_0 : x_n \in B(x, \epsilon) \cap E \setminus \{x\}$$

and the natural numbers n_0 and beyond are countably infinite (an injection of $\mathbb{N}$ into this set can easily be shown), thus x is an ω -accumulation point. The weakest sufficient condition is a T_1 space for such equivalence.

Now if the set E consists of some sequence $\{x_n\}_{n \in \mathbb{N}}$, then $E := \{x_n : n \in \mathbb{N}\}$, we see that x is a limit point of E if and only if there exists a convergent **subsequence** converging to x . This is not immediately trivial as one of the conditions we require for a subsequence is that:

$$\forall \{n_k\}_{k \in \mathbb{N}} : n_k < n_{k+1}$$

Observe the definition of sequential closure of some subset E :

Definition 1.2. *$\overline{E}$ is the closure of E if and only if*

$$\forall \{x_n\}_{n \in \mathbb{N}} \in E^{\mathbb{N}} : x_n \rightarrow x \implies x \in \overline{E}$$

So by the equivalence stated in Lemma 1.2, $\{x_n\}_{n \in \mathbb{N}}$ belongs to $E^{\mathbb{N}}$ as well (it is not guaranteed that $x \in E$), but by sequential closure x or the limit point must belong in $\overline{E}$.

Now steering our attention back to sequences, the limit of a sequence may not be a limit point. Consider an eventually constant or constant sequence. We see that it converges to whatever value it is eventually constant at; but there is an empty ϵ -punctured ball intersection. So a limit point is a limit of a specific type of sequence, but not vice versa.

This distinction will be quite crucial in the following section.

1.2 Limit Points and Sequences

In the previous section, we introduced the notion of a cluster point of a sequence, for which we proved:

$$x \text{ is a cluster point of } \{x_n\}_{n \in \mathbb{N}} \in X^{\mathbb{N}} \iff \exists \{n_k\}_{k \in \mathbb{N}} \in \mathbb{N}^{\mathbb{N}} : x_{n_k} \rightarrow x$$

but nothing prevented x_{n_k} from being perhaps a constant sequence such that all terms equal x itself. Now this section focused on limit points of **sets**. So consider the set:

$$S := \{x_n : n \in \mathbb{N}\}$$

which is the set of all possible values that appear in the sequence. Notice that the sequence allows for the repetition of values, while S does not. So if S is finite such that:

$$S = \{x_0, \dots, x_m\}$$

we notice that because a metric space is T_1 , each of these points can be isolated from each other. Thus, S has no limit point. Now assume S were countably infinite, which means the sequence has infinitely many distinct terms. Then:

Lemma 1.3.

$$x \text{ is a limit point of } S \iff \exists \{n_k\}_{k \in \mathbb{N}} \in \mathbb{N}^{\mathbb{N}} : x_{n_k} \rightarrow x \wedge (\forall k \in \mathbb{N} : x_{n_k} \neq x)$$

This aligns with Lemma 1.2 with the **extra condition** that it must be a subsequence, which implies:

$$n_k \rightarrow \infty \wedge \forall k \in \mathbb{N} : n_k < n_{k+1}$$

Proof. $\implies$: Define $\epsilon_m := 1/(m+1)$. Then:

$$\forall k \in \mathbb{N} : B(x, \epsilon_k) \cap S \setminus \{x\} \neq \emptyset$$

Then we have some $x_n \in S$ that belongs to the ball $B(x, \epsilon_k)$. Define this as the n_k term of the "sub"-sequence. Now, this does not necessarily guarantee that the sequence we constructed $\{n_k\}_{k \in \mathbb{N}}$ is necessarily strictly increasing.

By Sequential Bolzano Weierstrass, we notice that the indices are bounded below by 0 and that any sequence of these indices must contain either a strictly increasing subsequence or a non-increasing subsequence. Let us define the notion of dips in the sequence as:

$$D := \{m \in \mathbb{N} : (\forall j > m : n_j > n_m)\}$$

In the case that D is finite, we cannot find a strictly increasing subsequence, but we could possibly find a non-increasing subsequence. So, consider:

$$m_0 := \sup(D) + 1$$

so that the peaks are no longer included in the subsequence.

Then for all $m \geq m_0$, $m \notin D$, which tells us that:

$$\exists j > m : n_j \leq n_m$$

so we choose $m_{k+1} := \sup\{j > m_k : n_{m_j} \leq n_{m_k}\}$, which is possible because we have an upper bound. So, the initial value n_{m_0} acts as an upper bound and 0 is a lower bound for the indices.

This means either the sequence is finite (which is a contradiction), or that the sequence is constant/eventually constant. What this means is that the resultant subsequence $\{x_{n_{m_k}}\}_{k \in \mathbb{N}}$ takes a finite number of values.

Because the space is T_1 (this condition is necessary for the proof), then we can find a neighborhood that contains x and none of the values in the sequence, which too is a contradiction. Thus we must be able to find a strictly increasing subsequence of indices, such that:

$$\forall k \in \mathbb{N} : n_{m_k} < n_{m_{k+1}}$$

and since $x_{n_k} \rightarrow x$, we have that $x_{n_{m_k}} \rightarrow x$ and satisfies the conditions for a subsequence of $\{x_n\}_{n \in \mathbb{N}}$.

$\impliedby$: If there exists a convergent subsequence, then:

$$\forall \epsilon > 0, \exists k_0 \geq 0, \forall k \geq k_0 : x_{n_k} \in B(x, \epsilon)$$

Now given all terms of the subsequence do not equal x and S is countably infinite, we see that:

$$\forall \epsilon > 0 : B(x, \epsilon) \cap S \setminus \{x\} \neq \emptyset$$

and furthermore x is an ω -limit point. □

This lemma is the engine behind the equivalence of limit point compactness and sequential compactness (the forward direction utilizes first countability).

Going forward, we shall separate the terminologies so that we talk about cluster points of sequences/nets and limit/adherent points of sets. We provide a lemma for their equivalence below:

Another lemma requiring a stronger sufficient condition is the following:

Lemma 1.4. *If $\{x_n\}_{n \in \mathbb{N}} \in X^{\mathbb{N}}$ consists of all **DISTINCT** terms (each term appears at most once), then:*

$$x \text{ is a limit point of } S \iff x \text{ is a cluster point of } \{x_n\}_{n \in \mathbb{N}}$$

Proof. Lemma 0.2 provides us with the equivalence that x is a cluster point of the sequence if and only if there exists a convergent subsequence to x . Now since the sequence itself has all distinct points, so does the convergent subsequence.

One of the terms could perhaps be x , but since it appears at most once, omission of a finite number of points does not change convergence of the sequence. We prove this simply below. Let x be the n_j -th element of the original subsequence derived from the definition of cluster point. Then, for the new subsequence with x omitted:

$$\forall \epsilon > 0, \exists k'_0 := \max\{k_0, j + 1\}, \forall k \geq k'_0 : |x_{n_k} - x| < \epsilon$$

where k_0 comes from the convergence of the subsequence containing x . Thus we can always find a tail of the new sequence within the ϵ -neighborhood of x . If $k_0 < j$, then $k'_0 = j + 1$, and by convergence of the initial subsequence, the new one certainly converges as:

$$T'_{k'_0} = T_{j+1} \subseteq T_{k_0} \subseteq B(x, \epsilon)$$

In the case that $k_0 > j$, we see that:

$$T'_{k'_0} = T_{k_0} \subseteq B(x, \epsilon)$$

□

Lemma 1.4 and 1.5 will be key when discussing sequential compactness. Notice that for this proof, we used the sequential characterizations to draw equivalence; however, it can be done without first countability. The converse can be done in general topological spaces and follows from the definition of a cluster point.

The forward direction, requires T_1 . We prove by contradiction. Assume x is a limit point (thus an ω -limit point), but not a cluster point, such that:

$$\exists U_x \subseteq X, \exists n_0 \geq 0, \forall n \geq n_0 : x_n \notin U_x$$

Then there are n_0 values indexed by the values $0, \dots, n_0 - 1$ that may belong to U_x . One of those values could be x (but at most one, because S contains all distinct values), which contradicts the fact that x is an ω -limit point of S . While Theorem 1.3 deals with equivalence in $\mathbb{R}$ or general metric spaces (which are both T_1 and first countable), we assume the equivalence.

The reader will notice that Theorem 1.4 expands the previous theorem to more generality, and this distinction we have mentioned will be key to explaining the implications and how we can still have equivalence in non-first countable yet T_1 spaces.

1.3 Sequential Compactness

Theorem 1.1 (Sequential Bolzano Weierstrass). *Any bounded sequence has a convergent subsequence.*

To prove this fact, we show first that any sequence in $\mathbb{R}$ has a monotonic subsequence.

Proof. Let us define the following set, we call "peaks" of a sequence:

$$P := \{n \in \mathbb{N} : (\forall j > n : x_j < x_n)\}$$

In the case that P is countably infinite, then we set:

$$n_0 := \inf P \wedge \forall k > 0 : n_k := \inf (P \setminus \{n_0, \dots, n_{k-1}\})$$

In which case we are guaranteed that $\forall k \in \mathbb{N} : n_{k+1} > n_k$ which tells us that $x_{n_{k+1}} < x_{n_k}$, showing that there exists a strictly decreasing subsequence. In the case that P is finite, we choose the following:

$$n_0 := \sup(P) + 1$$

that way the peaks are fully omitted from the subsequence, as they will prove to be problematic in the construction. Then for any $k \in \mathbb{N}$, we are guaranteed that $n_k \notin P$ (since $\{n_k\}_{k \in \mathbb{N}}$ is strictly increasing and $n_0 \notin P$), which means:

$$\exists j > n_k : x_j \geq x_{n_k}$$

So we simply define:

$$\forall k \in \mathbb{N} : n_{k+1} := \inf \{j > n_k : x_j \geq x_{n_k}\}$$

in which case we obtain a non-decreasing subsequence. Now any bounded sequence has a monotone subsequence, which converges. What this means is given some sequence $\{x_n\}_{n \in \mathbb{N}}$, we have that:

$$\exists y \in \mathbb{R}, \exists r > 0, \forall n \in \mathbb{N} : x_n \in B(y, r)$$

so the sequence has a convergent subsequence within the ball, but such a subsequence may not converge within the ball. This is due to the topological idea that the limit point certainly belongs in the closure of the set but not necessarily in the open set. Consider the bounded sequence:

$$\{x_n\}_{n \in \mathbb{N}} \in (0, 1)^{\mathbb{N}} : \left(\forall n \in \mathbb{N} : x_n := \frac{1}{n+2} \right)$$

Then $x_n \rightarrow 0$ yet $0 \notin (0, 1)$. This idea of closedness plays a key role in sequential compactness. $\square$

Definition 1.3. *A sequentially compact interval of $\mathbb{R}$ is one for which every sequence has a convergent subsequence that converges to a point within the interval.*

The previous Theorem 1.1 leads to a key theorem:

Theorem 1.2. *An interval of $\mathbb{R}$ is sequentially compact if and only if it is closed and bounded.*

$\Leftarrow$: This direction follows from Sequential Bolzano Weierstrass. If the interval is bounded, then any sequence has a convergent monotone subsequence. Since it is closed, the limit of the sequence, which is an adherent point, belongs in the closure.

$\Rightarrow$: Consider any convergent sequence $\{x_n\}_{n \in \mathbb{N}}$ such that $\forall n \in \mathbb{N} : x_n \in I$. Then by sequential compactness:

$$\exists \{n_k\}_{k \in \mathbb{N}} : x_{n_k} \rightarrow x \wedge x \in I$$

which forces $x_n \rightarrow x$. Thus all convergent sequences converge to points within the set (which by sequential closure) means I is closed. Now assume the interval is not bounded, in which case:

$$\forall r > 0, \forall y \in \mathbb{R} : I \not\subseteq B(y, r)$$

Or equivalently (to bring about the sequential format, we use first countability):

$$\forall n \in \mathbb{N}, \forall y \in \mathbb{R}, \exists x \in I : x \notin B(y, n + 1)$$

Choose some arbitrary $y \in \mathbb{R}$. Then $\forall n \in \mathbb{N}$ choose x_n such that $x_n \notin B(y, n + 1)$, so that:

$$\forall n \in \mathbb{N} : |x_n - y| > n + 1 > 1/2$$

Now assume there existed some z such that some subsequence indexed by $\{n_k\}_{k \in \mathbb{N}}$ converged to z . Then:

$$\begin{aligned} \forall k \in \mathbb{N} : |x_{n_k} - y| &\leq |x_{n_k} - z| + |y - z| \\ \implies \forall k \in \mathbb{N} : ||x_{n_k} - y| - |y - z|| &\leq |x_{n_k} - z| \end{aligned}$$

Taking limit $k \rightarrow \infty$ we see that $n_k \rightarrow \infty$, thus:

$$||x_{n_k} - y| - |y - z|| \rightarrow 0$$

which is a contradiction because $|x_{n_k} - y| > n_k + 1$ which tells us that $|x_{n_k} - y| \rightarrow \infty$, so $x_{n_k} \not\rightarrow z$ and since z is arbitrary, this holds true for all such $z \in \mathbb{R}$.

Lemma 1.5. *For any set $I \subseteq \mathbb{R}$, I is bounded if and only if it is totally bounded (ONLY for $\mathbb{R}$).*

Proof. $\Leftarrow$: If I is bounded, then:

$$\exists r > 0, \exists y \in \mathbb{R} : I \subseteq B(y, r) \iff \exists r > 0, \exists y \in \mathbb{R}, \forall x \in I : x \in B(y, r)$$

We aim to show I is totally bounded, which means:

$$\forall \epsilon > 0, \exists x_0, \dots, x_m \in I : I \subseteq \bigcup_{i=0}^m B(x_i, \epsilon)$$

This converse direction is necessarily true; however, the forward direction is not necessarily true in all spaces. Consider the following:

$$M := \max\{|x_i - x_j| : 0 \leq i, j \leq m\}$$

Then, choose some x_i ; so without loss of generality, we choose x_0 :

$$\forall x \in I, \exists x_i : x \in B(x_i, \epsilon) \implies |x - x_0| \leq |x - x_i| + |x_i - x_0| < \epsilon + M$$

$\implies$: Now to prove the forward direction. We have that I is bounded, which means:

$$\exists y \in \mathbb{R}, \exists r > 0 : I \subseteq B(y, r)$$

Now we can show that $B(y, r)$ is totally bounded. Simply consider the uniform partition:

$$\Pi_B := \left\{ (y - r) + \frac{2r}{n}i : 0 \leq i \leq n \right\}$$

whereby:

$$\exists n \in \mathbb{N} : \frac{2r}{n} < \frac{\epsilon}{2}$$

$$\implies \forall \epsilon > 0, \exists \Pi_B : I \subseteq B(y, r) \subseteq \bigcup_{x_i \in \Pi_B} B(x_i, \epsilon/2)$$

Now $\forall x_i \in \Pi_B$ where $B(x_i, \epsilon/2) \cap I \neq \emptyset$, choose x'_i such that:

$$x'_i \in B(x_i, \epsilon/2) \cap I$$

and add it to the partition Π_I . Then we observe that:

$$\begin{aligned} & \forall x \in I, \exists x_i \in \Pi_B : x \in B(x_i, \epsilon/2) \\ \implies & \exists x'_i \in \Pi_I : |x - x'_i| \leq |x - x_i| + |x_i - x'_i| < \epsilon/2 + \epsilon/2 = \epsilon \end{aligned}$$

thus, I is totally bounded such that,

$$\forall \epsilon > 0, \exists \Pi_I : I \subseteq \bigcup_{x'_i \in \Pi_I} B(x'_i, \epsilon)$$

□

Now the main assumption we made here is that every open ball in $\mathbb{R}$ is totally bounded (which we can show via uniform partitions). The rest of the argument is not unique to $\mathbb{R}$. This can give insight into what spaces obey this Heine-Borel compactness property.

1.3.1 Bounded/Totally-Bounded Equivalence

NOTE: I will look into this later, it has something to do with finite dimensions/functional analysis. The main thing to investigate is in what spaces are open balls totally bounded.

1.4 Limit Point Compactness

We now discuss an equivalent form of compactness called limit point compactness (which due to the first countability of $\mathbb{R}$) is essentially equivalent to the sequential characterization.

Definition 1.4. A set $K \subseteq \mathbb{R}$ is limit point compact if for all infinite (countably or uncountably) sets $E \subseteq K$, there exists a limit point of E in K .

Theorem 1.3. A set K is limit point compact if and only if it is sequentially compact in $\mathbb{R}$.

$\implies$: If K is limit point compact, then every infinite subset is limit point compact. Then consider each sequence $\{x_n\}_{n \in \mathbb{N}} \in K^{\mathbb{N}}$ and define:

$$S := \{x_n : n \in \mathbb{N}\}$$

If S is finite, then by pigeonhole principle, we can find a constant convergent subsequence. If S is countably infinite, then there exists some point $x \in K$ which is a limit point of S . By Lemma 1.3, we have the existence of a subsequence with all terms being different from x converging to x .

$\Leftarrow$: Consider every infinite subset of K . From that we can always find a countably infinite subset. Let us define this subset as E . Then consider an arbitrary sequence $\{x_n\}_{n \in \mathbb{N}} \in E^{\mathbb{N}}$, such that $S := \{x_n : n \in \mathbb{N}\}$ is countably infinite and all terms of the sequence are unique (this is possible because E is countably infinite).

Then, the sequence must admit a convergent subsequence, which means it admits a cluster point. By Lemma 1.4, we see that this cluster point must be a limit point of $S \subseteq E$, thereby a limit point of E .

We now see that first countability can be avoided by weakening the notion of sequential compactness to cluster-point compactness:

Theorem 1.4. *A set K is limit point compact if and only if it is cluster-point compact in a T_1 space.*

Proof. $\implies$: This direction requires T_1 . For all sequences, if $S := \{x_n : n \in \mathbb{N}\}$ is finite, then there is a convergent subsequence by pigeonhole principle, which is a cluster point.

If S is countably infinite (then it admits a limit point) and $\{x_n\}_{n \in \mathbb{N}}$ has no constant subsequence (elements appear finitely many times), then take the subsequence omitting repetitions (resulting in a subsequence with entirely unique elements).

We utilize the alternative proof of Lemma 1.4, showing that in a T_1 space, if x is a limit point of S , then it is a cluster point of the sequence.

$\Leftarrow$: This direction requires neither T_1 nor first countability. Consider any countably infinite subset $E \subseteq K$ and enumerate it by the naturals, giving a sequence of distinct terms. Then if x is a cluster point of the sequence, we have that:

$$\begin{aligned} & \forall U_x, \forall n_0 \geq 0, \exists n \geq n_0 : x_n \in U_x \\ \implies & \forall U_x, \exists n \geq 0 : x_n \in U_x \implies \forall U_x : U_x \cap E \setminus \{x\} \neq \emptyset \end{aligned}$$

which follows from the definitions as well as the fact that the sequence consists of distinct terms. Thus, x is a limit point of E (not necessarily an ω -limit point, but this was not required by our given definition). $\square$

2 Topological Compactness

Open covers give us a way to talk about topological compactness in a highly geometric fashion. The two previous notions, limit point and sequential compactness are quite difficult to intuitively understand geometrically.

Definition 2.1. *Given some subset E of a topological space X , an open cover of E is a collection:*

$$\{O_\alpha : \alpha \in I \wedge O_\alpha \in \tau_X\}$$

such that:

$$E \subseteq \bigcup_{\alpha \in I} O_\alpha$$

We say that a subset E of a topological space X (which can include X itself) is topologically compact if EVERY open cover has a finite subcover. By the Heine-Borel definition in $\mathbb{R}$, we see that $(0, 1)$ is not compact. For this, define the open cover:

$$\left\{ \left(0, 1 - \frac{1}{n+1} \right) : n \in \mathbb{N} \right\}$$

which admits no finite subcover. Consider any finite subcollection of this open cover. We see that its union must be some interval $(0, 1 - 1/(m+1))$ for some $m \in \mathbb{N}$ (the largest m). However, we are guaranteed to always find some real number r such that:

$$1 - \frac{1}{m+1} < r < 1$$

which tells us that there cannot be any finite subcover.

Notice that if a metric space is topologically compact, then it must be totally bounded, as consider the following cover for some fixed $\epsilon > 0$ and $E \subseteq X$:

$$\{B(x, \epsilon) : x \in E\}$$

Since X is topologically compact, it admits a finite subcover, which means:

$$\exists x_0, \dots, x_m \in E : E \subseteq \bigcup_{0 \leq i \leq m} B(x_i, \epsilon)$$

The converse is not necessarily true, as evident by our example with $(0, 1)$. Because it is bounded, by Lemma 1.5, it is totally bounded (this is true only for spaces where open balls are totally bounded (possibly?)), yet we showed it is neither Heine-Borel compact, nor topologically compact.

2.1 Topological and Limit Point Compactness

Interestingly enough, these two notions are not equivalent in the general sense. We only have the following implication:

Theorem 2.1. *Given a general topological space X , if X is topologically compact, then it is limit point compact.*

Proof. We prove by contrapositive. First, if X is a finite space, then every open cover must be finite, and it is vacuously limit point compact (because all infinite subsets have a limit point, of which there are no

infinite subsets). So we deal with infinite topological spaces (those with infinite underlying points).

If X is not limit point compact, then taking an infinite subset E :

$$\exists E \subseteq X, \forall x \in X, \exists U_x : E \cap U_x \setminus \{x\} = \emptyset$$

Now take the collection of all such U_x as $\mathcal{U}_x := \{U_x : E \cap U_x \setminus \{x\} = \emptyset\}$ as an open cover (let us assume that each U_x is an open neighborhood). Then taking any finite subcover at points $\{x_0, \dots, x_m\}$, we see that each x_i is either in E or not in E .

In either case, we see that not all of E is covered by the finite subcover, since removing finite number of x_i points from E does not change the fact that it is infinite, which means there will always be points of E not covered by any finite subcover, and since $E \subseteq X$, this holds for X as well.

So, we have found an open cover $\mathcal{U}_x$ with no finite subcover, proving X is not topologically compact. □

3 Integration and Nets

The definition of Riemann and Riemann-Stieltjes integrability are fundamentally based on δ -nets and (equivalently or non-equivalently depending on the conditions) nets of partitions. We examine both varieties of integrals here as well as total variation.

3.1 Mesh of Partitions

Given a compact interval $[a, b] \subseteq \mathbb{R}$, we define a partition as:

$$\Pi_{[a,b]} := \{t_i : 0 \leq i \leq n\}$$

such that $t_0 = a$ and $t_n = b$ and:

$$\forall 0 \leq i \leq n-1 : t_i < t_{i+1}$$

so that:

$$a < t_1 < \dots < t_{n-1} < b$$

We then define the mesh of a partition Π as the following:

$$||\Pi|| := \max_{0 \leq i \leq n-1} |t_{i+1} - t_i|$$

We furthermore say Π_1 is a refinement of or is finer than Π_0 if $\Pi_0 \subseteq \Pi_1$. Due to the uniqueness of the supremum, it is guaranteed that the mesh relation is a function. The following lemma will prove to be quite useful:

Lemma 3.1. *If $\Pi_1 \supseteq \Pi_0$, then $||\Pi_1|| \leq ||\Pi_0||$.*

Proof. Consider the points $\{x_0, \dots, x_m\}$ to be added to the partition Π_0 resulting in Π_1 , such that:

$$\Pi_0 := \{t_i : 0 \leq i \leq n\}$$

$$\Pi_1 := \{u_j : 0 \leq j \leq n+m\}$$

such that $u_0 = a$ and $u_{n+m} = b$. We further define:

$$\forall 0 \leq i \leq n-1 : T_i := \{[u_j, u_{j+1}] : 0 \leq j \leq n+m-1 \wedge [u_j, u_{j+1}] \subseteq [t_i, t_{i+1}]\}$$

Now we use basic properties of outer measure where $A \subseteq B \implies |A| \leq |B|$, which leads to the following:

$$\forall 0 \leq i \leq n-1, \forall [u_j, u_{j+1}] \in T_i : |[u_j, u_{j+1}]| \leq |[t_i, t_{i+1}]|$$

Since this is true for all $i \in [0, n-1]$, we see that:

$$\begin{aligned} \forall 0 \leq i \leq n-1, \forall [u_j, u_{j+1}] \in T_i : |[u_j, u_{j+1}]| &\leq |[t_i, t_{i+1}]| \leq ||\Pi_0|| \\ \implies \forall 0 \leq j \leq n+m-1 : |[u_j, u_{j+1}]| &\leq |[t_i, t_{i+1}]| \leq ||\Pi_0|| \end{aligned}$$

and because we have an upper bound on the measure of each interval, we get that $||\Pi_1|| \leq ||\Pi_0||$. $\square$

The idea of the mesh will be important in defining (Willard) subnets where the base directed set is $(\Pi, \supseteq)$ and the function f is the mesh function.

3.2 Riemann-Stieltjes Integrability

Given two functions $f, g \in \mathbb{R}^{\mathbb{R}}$, we call f the integrand and g the integrator.

Definition 3.1. *The function f is Riemann-Stieltjes integrable on $[a, b]$ (with respect to g) if:*

$$\forall \epsilon > 0, \exists \delta_0 > 0, \forall \Pi : \|\Pi\| < \delta_0 \implies \left| S(f, g, \Pi) - \int_a^b f dg \right| < \epsilon$$

Let us now examine how nets play a role here. Let P be the set of all finite partitions of $[a, b] \subseteq \mathbb{R}$. We say that $\Pi_1 \leq \Pi_0$ iff $\|\Pi_1\| \leq \|\Pi_0\|$.

Thus $(P, \leq)$ is a directed set, because:

$$\forall \Pi_0, \Pi_1 \in P : \Pi_1, \Pi_0 \subseteq \Pi_1 \cup \Pi_0 \implies \Pi_1 \cup \Pi_0 \leq \Pi_1, \Pi_0$$

by Lemma 3.1, showing P is downward directed (the other properties follow from the mesh function mapping to $\mathbb{R}$). The net we will define will then be the net of Stieltjes sums $\{S(f, g, \Pi)\}_{\Pi \in P}$:

$$\forall \Pi \in P : S(f, g, \Pi) := \sum_{i=1}^n f(t_i^*)(t_i - t_{i-1})$$

For brevity, we shall also use the following notation for Stieltjes sums:

$$S(f, g, \Pi) = \sum_{T_i \in \Pi} f(t_i^*) \Delta T_i$$

where each $T_i := [t_{i-1}, t_i]$. Such a net converges if:

$$\forall \epsilon > 0, \exists \Pi_\epsilon \in P, \forall \Pi \leq \Pi_\epsilon : S(f, g, \Pi) \in B\left(\int_a^b f dg, \epsilon\right)$$

Lemma 3.2. *The conditions in Definition 3.1 and the convergence of $\{S(f, g, \Pi)\}_{\Pi \in P}$ are equivalent.*

Proof. $\implies$: If there exists some $\delta_0 > 0$, then we can take the uniform net Π_ϵ with mesh at most $\frac{\delta_0}{2}$. By the Archimedian property:

$$\frac{\delta_0}{2(b-a)} > 0 \implies \exists n \in \mathbb{N} : 1 \leq n \frac{\delta_0}{2(b-a)} \implies \frac{b-a}{n} \leq \frac{\delta_0}{2}$$

So we can define Π_ϵ as the following:

$$\Pi_\epsilon := \left\{ a + i \cdot \frac{b-a}{n} : 0 \leq i \leq n \right\}$$

Then:

$$\forall \epsilon > 0, \exists \Pi_\epsilon \in P, \forall \Pi \in P : \Pi \leq \Pi_\epsilon \implies \|\Pi\| \leq \|\Pi_\epsilon\| \leq \frac{\delta_0}{2} \leq \delta_0$$

and by the criterion in Definition 3.1:

$$\implies S(f, g, \Pi) \in B\left(\int_a^b f dg, \epsilon\right)$$

showing that the net $S(f, g, \Pi) \rightarrow \int_a^b f dg$.

$\Leftarrow$: We now prove the converse. We have the convergence of our Stieltjes sum net:

$$\forall \epsilon > 0, \exists \Pi_\epsilon, \forall \Pi \leq \Pi_\epsilon : S(f, g, \Pi) \in B \left(\int_a^b f dg, \epsilon \right)$$

Now take $\delta_0 := \|\Pi_\epsilon\|/2$, so we get:

$$\begin{aligned} \forall \epsilon > 0, \exists \delta_0 > 0, \forall \Pi \in P : \|\Pi\| < \delta_0 &\implies \|\Pi\| < \|\Pi_\epsilon\|/2 < \|\Pi_\epsilon\| \\ \implies \Pi \leq \Pi_\epsilon &\implies S(f, g, \Pi) \in B \left(\int_a^b f dg, \epsilon \right) \end{aligned}$$

□

3.2.1 Alternative Integrability Criteria

Notice the generality in the net $\{S(f, g, \Pi)\}_{\Pi \in P}$ that we constructed. Lemma 3.1 tells us that if $\Pi_1 \supseteq \Pi_0$, then in this case $\Pi_1 \leq \Pi_0$ or equivalently $\|\Pi_1\| \leq \|\Pi_0\|$.

The converse however is not necessarily true. If $\Pi_1 \leq \Pi_0$ that does not necessarily mean that $\Pi_1 \supseteq \Pi_0$. We now look at a more specific definition:

Definition 3.2. *The function f is Riemann-Stieltjes integrable on $[a, b]$ with respect to g if*

$$\forall \epsilon > 0, \exists \Pi_\epsilon \in P, \forall \Pi \supseteq \Pi_\epsilon : S(f, g, \Pi) \in B \left(\int_a^b f dg, \epsilon \right)$$

4 Arzela-Ascoli and Nets